

MARKETING MANAGEMENT

Course Code: IM345AT | Semester IV | L:T:P 3:0:0 | 45 Hours

UNIT V

Conversion Optimization & Digital Analytics

Unit V closes the course by turning traffic into revenue and data into decisions. The first half is conversion optimization built around the AIDAS model — what visitors want, how to optimise the key elements of a page, and how to increase the effect of a landing page. The second half is digital analytics — its evolution, the end-to-end customer experience, and the analyst's influence on the business as a change agent.

TOPICS COVERED IN THIS UNIT

Conversion Optimization: What is AIDAS and its role; website optimization; what visitors want to see on the website; how to optimize key elements and increase the effect of landing on a particular page.

Digital Analytics: Evolution of Digital Analytics; information about end-to-end customer experience; analyst's influence on business; role as a change agent.

ABOUT THESE NOTES

These notes are **unofficial**. They have been documented by students from **Vikram Sir's handwritten notes, lecture slides and classroom sessions**, and restructured to follow the official IM345AT syllabus unit by unit. Where the source notes were incomplete, the gaps have been filled from standard marketing-management texts and clearly integrated into the same flow. Every previous-year question in the question bank at the end has been extracted verbatim from the actual RVCE CIE and SEE papers for this course. This document is a study aid and is not issued, endorsed or verified by the Department of Industrial Engineering and Management or by RV College of Engineering. Always cross-check against the official syllabus and your own class notes.



Semester: IV						
MARKETING MANAGEMENT						
Category: Professional Core Course (Theory)						
Course Code	:	IM345AT		CIE Marks	:	100 Marks
Credits: L:T:P	:	3:0:0		SEE Marks	:	100 Marks
Total Hours	:	45L		SEE Duration	:	3.00 Hours
UNIT-I						07Hrs
Introduction to Digital Marketing: Principles of Digital Marketing; Digital Marketing Channels; Tools to Create Buyer Persona; Competitor Research Tools, Website Analysis Tools, etc. Content Marketing: Content Marketing Concepts & Strategies; Planning, Creating, Distributing & Promoting Content; Optimize Website UX & Landing Pages; Measure Impact; Metrics & Performance; Using Content Research for Opportunities, etc.						
UNIT-II						08Hrs
Social Media Marketing: Introduction; Major Social Media Platforms for Marketing; Developing Data-driven Audience & Campaign Insights; Social Media for Business; Creation & Optimization of Social Media Campaigns, etc. Search Engine Optimization: Search Engine Optimization Fundamentals; Keywords and SEO Content Plan; SEO & Business Objectives; Writing SEO Content; On-site & off-site SEO; Optimize Organic Search Ranking, etc.						
UNIT-III						07Hrs
Web Analytics & Google Analytics: Google Analytics Tools; Web Analytics Tools, etc. E-mail Marketing: Effective E-mail Campaigns; E-mail Plan; E-mail Marketing Campaign Analysis; Measuring Conversions & keeping up, etc.						
UNIT-IV						07Hrs
Web Design: Web design, optimization of websites; Publishing a basic website; User-centered Design and Website Optimization; Design Principles and Website Copy; Website Metrics & Developing Insight, etc. Mobile Marketing: Difference between mobile advertising and marketing, utilizing mobile marketing for sales promotions, online applications, etc.						
UNIT-V						07Hrs
Conversion Optimization: What is AIDAS and its role; website optimization; what visitors want to see on the website; how to optimize key element and increase the effect of landing on a particular page Digital Analytics: Evolution of Digital Analytics, information about end-to-end customer experience, analyst's influence on business, role as a change agent, etc.						

Course Outcomes: After completing the course, the students will be able to	
CO1	Differentiate the benefits drawn by updated marketing mix from traditional marketing mix for effective marketing management there by to stay competitive in today's global market-place.
CO2	Develop an effective holistic marketing atmosphere to efficiently face the challenges in dynamically changing market.
CO3	Formulate a potential marketing plan to effectively reach the targeted market segments, by delivering the value to targeted customers through practicing sound marketing research.
CO4	Create new channels to improvise marketing to achieve and maintain competitive position in globalized market-place.

Reference Books	
1.	Marketing Management, Philip Kotler, Kevin Lane Keller, 15 th Edition, 2016, Pearson, ISBN:978-93-325-5718-5
2.	Digital Marketing - Strategy, Implementation & Practice, Dave Chaffey, Fiona Ellis – Chadwick, 7 th Edition, 2019, Pearson, ISBN - 9781292241623, 1292241624
3.	Marketing Research, Donald S Tull, Del I Hawkins, 6 th Edition, Prentice Hall India, ISBN: 8120309618
4.	Marketing Management - A South Asian Perspective, Philip Kotler, Kevin Lane Keller, Abraham Koshy, MithileshwarJha, 14 th Edition, 2013, Pearson, ISBN –978-81-317-6716-0
5.	Marketing Research, David A. Aaker, V. Kumar, George S. Day, 9 th Edition, 2008, John Wiley & Sons, ISBN: 978-265-1791-6



RUBRIC FOR THE CONTINUOUS INTERNAL EVALUATION (THEORY)		
#	COMPONENTS	MARKS
1.	QUIZZES: Quizzes will be conducted in online/offline mode. TWO QUIZZES will be conducted & Each Quiz will be evaluated for 10 Marks. THE SUM OF TWO QUIZZES WILL BE THE FINAL QUIZ MARKS.	20
2.	TESTS: Students will be evaluated in test, descriptive questions with different complexity levels (Revised Bloom's Taxonomy Levels: Remembering, Understanding, Applying, Analyzing, Evaluating, and Creating). TWO tests will be conducted. Each test will be evaluated for 50 Marks, adding upto 100 Marks. FINAL TEST MARKS WILL BE REDUCED TO 40 MARKS.	40
3.	EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING: Students will be evaluated for their creativity and practical implementation of the problem. Case study-based teaching learning (10), Program specific requirements (10), Video based seminar/presentation/demonstration (20) ADDING UPTO 40	40
MAXIMUM MARKS FOR THE CIE THEORY		100

RUBRIC FOR SEMESTER END EXAMINATION (THEORY)		
Q. NO.	CONTENTS	MARKS
PART A		
1	Objective type questions covering entire syllabus	20
PART B (Maximum of TWO Sub-divisions only)		
2	Unit 1: (Compulsory)	16
3 & 4	Unit 2: (Internal Choice)	16
5 & 6	Unit 3: (Internal Choice)	16
7 & 8	Unit 4: (Internal Choice)	16
9 & 10	Unit 5: (Internal Choice)	16
TOTAL		100

5.1 Conversion Optimization — Fundamentals

5.1.1 Definitions

Conversion — the completion of a defined, valuable action by a visitor — a purchase, a form submission, a sign-up, a download, a call or an app install.

Conversion rate — the percentage of visitors who complete that action. **Conversion Rate = (Conversions ÷ Total Visitors) × 100.**

DEFINITION

Conversion Rate Optimization (CRO) is the systematic process of increasing the percentage of visitors who complete a desired action, by using analytics, user research and controlled experiments to remove friction and strengthen persuasion.

5.1.2 Why CRO Matters

- It **compounds on all future traffic** — a 20% lift applies to every visitor thereafter, at zero additional acquisition cost.
- It is usually **cheaper than buying more traffic**; doubling the conversion rate has the same revenue effect as doubling the ad budget, but without the recurring spend.
- It **improves the ROI of every other channel simultaneously** — SEO, paid, e-mail and social all deposit into the same funnel.
- It **lowers customer acquisition cost** and therefore improves the LTV:CAC ratio.
- It **replaces opinion with evidence**, ending unresolvable internal debates about design.

5.1.3 The Conversion Funnel

SEE Oct/Nov 2023 asked (Q9a, 8 marks): “Describe the conversion funnel in digital marketing. What are the key stages and how can business identify and address drop offs in the funnel?”

Stage	What happens	Typical metric	Common cause of drop-off
Awareness	The prospect first encounters the brand	Impressions, reach	Wrong targeting; weak creative
Interest / Consideration	They engage and evaluate	Sessions, pages per session, time on site	Poor message match; unclear value proposition
Desire / Intent	They want the product and compare options	Add-to-cart rate, product page views, wishlist adds	Price opacity; missing proof; weak differentiation
Action / Conversion	They complete the purchase or enquiry	Checkout completion, form submission, conversion rate	Long forms; forced registration; hidden costs; payment friction
Satisfaction / Retention	They receive value and return	Repeat purchase rate, retention, NPS	Poor delivery, weak support, no post-purchase communication

Identifying drop-offs

1. **Build the funnel in analytics** — define each step as an event and use funnel exploration to see the exact percentage lost at each transition.

2. **Segment the funnel** by device, channel, geography and new-vs-returning; the aggregate figure usually hides where the real failure is.
3. **Add qualitative diagnosis** — heatmaps, scroll maps and session recordings show *why* users leave at the identified step.
4. **Ask the user directly** — exit-intent surveys and post-purchase questions capture the reason in their own words.
5. **Compare against benchmarks** to judge whether a step is genuinely weak or simply normal for the category.

Addressing drop-offs

- **Awareness → Interest:** improve message match between the ad and the landing page; sharpen the headline.
- **Interest → Desire:** add proof — reviews, ratings, demonstrations, comparison tables; make pricing transparent.
- **Desire → Action:** shorten the form, allow guest checkout, show total cost including shipping upfront, offer multiple payment methods, add a progress indicator, and place trust badges at the payment step.
- **Action → Satisfaction:** confirm the order immediately, communicate proactively during fulfilment, make returns easy, and follow up for a review.
- **Across all stages:** improve page speed, fix mobile-specific failures, and A/B test the single highest-loss step first.

5.2 The AIDAS Model

AIDAS is the single most examined topic in this unit — it has appeared in the SEE of Oct/Nov 2023, the SEE of June/July 2025, the Improvement CIE of 28 August 2024 and the Improvement CIE of 4 June 2025.

5.2.1 What AIDAS Stands For

EXAM ANSWER (2 marks)

A — Attention · I — Interest · D — Desire · A — Action · S — Satisfaction.

AIDAS is a hierarchy-of-effects model describing the sequence of psychological states a prospect passes through, from first exposure to a brand to post-purchase satisfaction. It extends the classical **AIDA** model by adding **Satisfaction**, which converts a one-time buyer into a retained customer and an advocate.

5.2.2 The Five Stages in Detail

Stage	Psychological state	What the marketer must do	Website elements that deliver it
Attention	"Something has caught my eye."	Break through indifference in the first few seconds	Hero headline, striking visual, above-the-fold offer, ad message match, page speed
Interest	"This might be relevant to me."	Convert curiosity into engagement by showing relevance	Benefit-led sub-headline, scannable content, product images and video, clear navigation
Desire	"I want this."	Turn interest into preference through proof and emotional appeal	Testimonials, ratings, case studies, comparison tables, guarantees, scarcity and urgency cues, transparent pricing
Action	"I am buying it."	Remove every obstacle between wanting and buying	One prominent CTA, short form, guest checkout, multiple payment options, security badges, no hidden costs
Satisfaction	"I am glad I did."	Ensure the delivered experience meets or exceeds the promise	Order confirmation, proactive updates, easy returns, responsive support, onboarding content, loyalty programme, review request

5.2.3 Why 'Satisfaction' Is the Critical Component

EXAM ANSWER — SEE Jun/Jul 2025 (2 marks)

"Why is the 'Satisfaction' component important in the AIDAS model?"

Because the sale is not the end of the funnel. Satisfaction determines whether the customer **returns, repurchases, recommends and defends the brand**. Its importance rests on the economics: the probability of selling to an existing customer is **60–70%** against **5–20%** for a new prospect, and repeat customers spend up to **67% more**. A dissatisfied customer, by contrast, does not merely fail to return — in a digital environment they broadcast the failure through reviews and social media, damaging future acquisition. Satisfaction therefore converts a transaction into a relationship and turns customers into an unpaid distribution channel.

5.2.4 The Role of AIDAS in Conversion Optimization

AIDAS is not merely descriptive — it is a **diagnostic tool**. Its role in conversion optimization is to tell you *which* element to fix.

1. **It locates the failure.** High bounce means Attention failed. High bounce after scrolling means Interest failed. High add-to-cart with low checkout means Desire succeeded but Action failed. High refunds and low repeat rate mean Satisfaction failed.
2. **It maps content to psychological state**, so each page section has a defined job rather than being decorative.
3. **It sequences the page** — attention at the top, interest through the middle, desire immediately before the CTA, action at the point of decision, satisfaction promised in advance through guarantees and delivered afterwards.
4. **It generates testable hypotheses** — “the CTA fails because Desire is unsupported; adding ratings above the button will raise conversions.”
5. **It prevents over-optimising one stage.** A beautiful attention-grabbing page with no proof converts no better than a plain one.

5.2.5 Structuring a Product Landing Page with AIDAS

SEE June/July 2025 asked (Q10b, 8 marks): “Analyze how a company can use the AIDAS model to structure content on its product landing page.”

Page section	AIDAS stage	Content
Hero (above the fold)	Attention	A benefit headline matching the ad, a strong product image or short video, and the offer visible without scrolling
Value proposition band	Interest	A sub-headline plus three to four benefit statements answering “what's in it for me”, written in scannable form
Proof section	Desire	Star ratings, customer testimonials with photographs, before-and-after visuals, a comparison table against alternatives, awards and certifications
Offer & urgency band	Desire	Transparent pricing, what is included, a limited-time offer with a countdown, and a risk-reversal guarantee
Conversion block	Action	One dominant, high-contrast CTA button with active benefit copy, a short form, guest checkout, payment logos and a security badge
Reassurance footer	Satisfaction	Delivery timelines, returns and cancellation policy, support contact, FAQ, and post-purchase onboarding promise

THE STRUCTURING PRINCIPLE

Each section has **one psychological job**. If a section cannot be assigned to an AIDAS stage, it is probably noise and should be deleted — which is the same conclusion the design principle “*omit needless words*” reaches from the other direction.

5.3 What Visitors Want to See on a Website

This is examined both as a 2-mark question (“two key elements visitors expect on a well-optimized landing page”) and as a 10-mark question.

Visitor question	What must be present
“Am I in the right place?”	A clear headline stating what is offered and for whom, above the fold
“What’s in it for me?”	Benefit-led copy rather than feature lists or company history
“Can I trust you?”	Testimonials, star ratings, client logos, certifications, guarantees, real photographs, a physical address
“What does it cost?”	Transparent pricing or at least a clear range; hidden pricing is a leading cause of abandonment
“What do I do next?”	One prominent, unambiguous call-to-action
“Can I find what I came for?”	Simple, conventional navigation and a working search
“Is it fast?”	A page loading in under about three seconds
“Does it work on my phone?”	A fully responsive, mobile-first layout
“Is it safe to pay here?”	HTTPS, recognised payment logos, a clear privacy and returns policy
“How do I reach a human?”	Visible contact options and stated response times

5.3.1 The Psychology Behind It

“DON'T MAKE ME THINK.” — Krug's First Law

A person of average or below-average ability must be able to work out how to accomplish the task. It must be **self-evident and self-explanatory**.

Users do not read pages; they **scan, satisfice and muddle through**. They choose the first option that plausibly works rather than the best one. Three reasons they do not read instructions: it isn't important to them, they are on a mission and know they don't need everything, and if something works they stick with it rather than seeking a better way. Design must therefore follow visual hierarchy, omit needless words, make clickables obvious, and provide breadcrumbs and street signs.

5.4 Optimizing Key Elements of a Page

5.4.1 The Headline

- **Restate the promise** made by the ad, e-mail or search result that brought the visitor — message match is the single largest lever on landing-page conversion.
- **Be specific and quantified** — “Kerala backwaters, 4 nights from ₹18,999” beats “Unforgettable holidays”.
- **Lead with the benefit**, not the product name or the company name.
- **Keep it short enough to be read in one glance** and set it as the visually dominant element on the page.
- **Support it with a sub-headline** that adds the second most important piece of information.

5.4.2 The Call-to-Action (CTA)

- **One dominant CTA per page.** Two competing CTAs halve the conversion rate of both.
- **High contrast** — reserve one accent colour exclusively for actions, so the eye finds it instantly.
- **Active, benefit-led, first-person copy** — “Get my free trial” outperforms “Submit” or “Click here”.
- **Positioned above the fold and repeated** at natural decision points down the page.
- **Adequate size and tap target** — at least 44×44 pixels on mobile.
- **Reassurance microcopy beneath the button** — “No card required · Cancel anytime · Takes 30 seconds”.

5.4.3 Visuals

- **Show the actual product or outcome**, not generic stock imagery, which reads as inauthentic and lowers trust.
- **Use real customer photographs** in testimonials — faces materially increase credibility.
- **Add short video** — 77% of consumers have been convinced to buy after watching a video.
- **Direct attention with the image** — a person in the image looking toward the CTA measurably increases attention to it.
- **Optimise every image** for weight and format so the visual does not destroy the speed it was meant to support.

5.4.4 Forms

- **Remove every field you will not act on.** Each additional field reduces completion.
- **Allow guest checkout** — forced registration is one of the largest single causes of cart abandonment.
- **Use smart defaults, auto-fill and postcode lookup** to reduce typing on mobile.
- **Validate inline**, not on submit, and write error messages that say how to fix the problem.
- **Show a progress indicator** for multi-step forms.
- **Use the right keyboard type** on mobile for each field.

5.4.5 Trust Signals and Social Proof

SEE Oct/Nov 2023 asked (Q9b, 8 marks): “Explain the concept of social proof and its impact on conversion rates. Provide examples of how business can use social proof effectively in marketing.”

DEFINITION

Social proof is the psychological phenomenon whereby people assume the actions and opinions of others reflect the correct behaviour in a given situation — so, uncertain about a decision, a buyer looks at what other buyers did.

Impact on conversion rates: social proof reduces perceived risk, which is the dominant barrier at the Desire → Action transition. It substitutes borrowed credibility for a brand the visitor does not yet know; roughly 90% of people believe what peers say about a brand while only about 48% trust what businesses say directly. It also shortens deliberation by supplying a decision shortcut, and it raises average order value when the proof is attached to higher-tier options.

Type of social proof	How to use it
Customer testimonials	Short quotes with a real name, photograph and specific outcome, placed adjacent to the CTA

Type of social proof	How to use it
Star ratings and reviews	Aggregate rating on product pages and in search rich results; display negative reviews too, since an all-perfect page reads as fake
User counts	"Joined by 40,000 students", "2 million orders delivered"
Case studies	Detailed, quantified success stories for high-consideration B2B purchases
Client and media logos	"As used by" and "As featured in" bands
Expert endorsement	Certifications, professional bodies, specialist reviews
Influencer and celebrity proof	Borrowed audience trust, disclosed as sponsored
User-generated content	Real customer photographs and videos, reposted with permission
Real-time activity notifications	"12 people are viewing this now", "Booked 4 times today" — effective, but must be truthful
Wisdom of the crowd	"Most popular plan", "Best seller" badges guiding choice

5.4.6 Page Speed and Mobile

- A page loading in over three seconds loses a large share of mobile visitors before it is ever seen — speed is a conversion element, not a technical detail.
- **Compress and modernise images**, minify scripts, enable caching and a CDN, and lazy-load below-the-fold content.
- **Design mobile-first**, since most traffic and most abandonment now occur on mobile.

5.4.7 The Optimization Workflow

1. **Measure** — locate the weakest step in the funnel using analytics.
2. **Diagnose** — use heatmaps, session recordings and surveys to find out why.
3. **Hypothesise** — state a specific, falsifiable prediction tied to one variable.
4. **Prioritise** — rank hypotheses by expected impact against implementation effort.
5. **Test** — run an A/B or multivariate test to statistical significance.
6. **Implement** the winner.
7. **Re-measure and repeat** — CRO is a continuous loop, not a project.

5.5 Digital Analytics

5.5.1 Definition

DEFINITION — CIE-III, June 2026 (2 marks)

Digital analytics is the collection, measurement, analysis and interpretation of digital data in order to improve business performance and customer experience.

The distinction from web analytics matters. **Web analytics** is confined to website behaviour. **Digital analytics** is broader — it unifies website, mobile app, social, e-mail, paid media, CRM, offline and support data into a single view of the customer, and its purpose is to inform business decisions rather than merely to report on a channel.

5.5.2 How Digital Analytics Influences Business Decisions

EXAM ANSWER — CIE-III, June 2026 (2 marks)

Digital analytics provides **customer insights and performance data** that help businesses improve marketing strategies and customer engagement. Concretely, it determines where budget is allocated, which products are developed, which segments are targeted, which experiences are fixed first, and what the business forecasts.

5.5.3 The Evolution of Digital Analytics

A 10-mark question in the Improvement CIE of 4 June 2025: “Trace the evolution of digital analytics and its growing importance in delivering a seamless end-to-end customer experience.”

Era	What was measured	Tools and methods	Limitation
1. Server log analysis (1990s)	Hits, file requests, bandwidth	Raw server logs, log parsers	Counted files, not people; caches and bots corrupted the data
2. Page-tag web analytics (early 2000s)	Pageviews, visits, referrers, bounce rate	JavaScript tags; Urchin, then Google Analytics (2005)	Session-based and site-siloed; no view of the person across visits
3. Visitor and goal analytics (mid–late 2000s)	Goals, funnels, e-commerce revenue, segments	Goal tracking, funnel visualisation, A/B testing tools	Last-click attribution; ignored the rest of the journey
4. Multi-channel and social analytics (2010s)	Cross-channel attribution, social listening, mobile app analytics	Multi-channel funnels, mobile SDKs, social insight platforms	Data still fragmented across separate platforms
5. User-centric and event-based analytics (late 2010s onward)	The individual user across devices and sessions; every interaction as an event	GA4 , Mixpanel, Amplitude, Google Tag Manager, cross-device identity	Requires disciplined measurement planning and governance
6. Unified, predictive and privacy-first analytics (present)	End-to-end customer experience; predicted churn and lifetime value; consent-governed first-party data	Customer Data Platforms, data warehouses, machine learning, server-side tagging, consent management	Privacy regulation and cookie deprecation constrain tracking; modelling replaces some observation

The direction of travel is consistent across all six eras: from **counting files** → **counting visits** → **counting conversions** → **understanding people** → **predicting behaviour**, and from **channel-siloed reporting** → a

unified end-to-end view. Each shift moved analytics closer to the customer and closer to the boardroom.

5.6 The End-to-End Customer Experience

5.6.1 What It Means

EXAM ANSWER — SEE Jun/Jul 2025 (2 marks)

The **end-to-end customer experience** in digital analytics means measuring and understanding the **complete customer journey across every touchpoint and every stage** — from the first anonymous impression, through research, comparison, purchase, delivery and support, to repeat purchase and advocacy — as a single connected experience rather than as a set of disconnected channel reports.

5.6.2 Why the Siloed View Fails

- A visitor may discover the brand on Instagram, research it on YouTube, compare it on Google, read reviews on Amazon and buy in a store. Channel-level reporting credits only the last touch and misleads budget allocation.
- **The modern journey is not a funnel.** It is a **decision constellation** — a network of micro-decisions happening in different places at the same time. Optimising for visibility in one place while the customer is deciding everywhere else produces the classic symptom: **traffic looks healthy but conversions are flat.**
- Silos also hide experience failures that span teams — for example, a marketing promise the fulfilment process cannot keep.

5.6.3 What End-to-End Analytics Requires

1. **A unified customer identity** across web, app, e-mail, CRM and offline systems.
2. **A consistent event taxonomy** so the same action means the same thing in every system.
3. **Journey and path analysis**, not just page reports.
4. **Multi-touch attribution** rather than last-click.
5. **Voice-of-customer data** — surveys, NPS, reviews and support tickets — joined to behavioural data.
6. **Post-purchase and service data**, so the measurement does not stop at the transaction.
7. **Consent and privacy governance** built into the collection layer.

5.6.4 Business Value

- **Accurate budget allocation** based on true contribution rather than last-click credit.
- **Identification of the highest-friction moment** in the whole journey, not the whole page.
- **Personalisation** that is consistent across channels rather than contradictory.
- **Improved retention**, because the analysis continues past the purchase.
- **Predictive capability** — churn risk and lifetime value modelled from journey behaviour.

5.7 The Analyst's Influence on the Business

5.7.1 Data Requires Interpretation

A theme repeated throughout the lecture material: **data requires interpretation, and errors compound at every step of the chain.**

Step	What happens	Where it can go wrong
1. Product design	Someone at Google designs the analytics tool	The product may be flawed
2. Tool setup	The tool is installed and preferences are set	The setup may be wrong — mis-tagged pages, duplicate tracking, wrong filters
3. Data output	The tool generates reports	Sampling, bot traffic, consent gaps
4. Human interpretation	Someone reads the data	The interpretation may be wrong — correlation read as causation, averages hiding segments
5. Business action	Reports are used to make choices	The final decision may be wrong

THE ANALYST'S REAL JOB

A number is not a fact and a report is not an insight. The analyst's value lies in steps 2, 4 and 5 — instrumenting correctly, interpreting honestly, and translating the interpretation into a decision the business can act on. **An organisation with excellent tools and poor interpretation makes confident wrong decisions faster.**

5.7.2 How the Analyst Influences the Business

1. **Sets the measurement agenda.** By defining which KPIs are reported, the analyst determines what the organisation pays attention to.
2. **Arbitrates between opinions.** Analytics ends debates that seniority would otherwise decide.
3. **Reallocates money.** Channel and campaign analysis directly redirects marketing budget.
4. **Prioritises the roadmap.** Funnel analysis determines which product and site fixes are built first.
5. **Quantifies risk and opportunity.** Forecasts and cohort models inform pricing, inventory and hiring.
6. **Protects against self-deception.** The analyst is the person who reports that the favourite campaign did not work.
7. **Translates.** The analyst converts technical measurement into business language that executives can act on — this, more than technical skill, determines their influence.

5.7.3 The Analyst as a Change Agent

The syllabus explicitly names the analyst's *role as a change agent*. Reporting numbers is not change; changing what the organisation does is.

From (reporting function)	To (change agent)
Produces scheduled reports on request	Proactively identifies problems nobody asked about
Answers "what happened?"	Answers "why did it happen, and what should we do?"
Describes performance	Recommends a specific action with an expected outcome
Owned by one team	Embedded across marketing, product, sales and service

From (reporting function)	To (change agent)
Measures after the fact	Designs experiments before decisions are made
Presents data	Builds the business case and drives adoption of the decision

What being a change agent requires

- **Business literacy** — understanding the commercial model well enough to know which questions matter.
- **Credibility** — data quality and honest reporting, including inconvenient findings.
- **Storytelling** — a finding that cannot be communicated will not change anything.
- **Stakeholder relationships** — influence flows through trust, not through dashboards.
- **A bias towards experimentation** — proposing tests rather than asserting opinions.
- **Follow-through** — measuring whether the implemented change actually worked, and saying so.

Barriers a change agent must overcome

- **Data distrust** — “the numbers must be wrong” is the standard first response to unwelcome findings.
- **HiPPO decision-making** — the Highest Paid Person's Opinion overriding evidence.
- **Vanity metrics** — organisations preferring numbers that always go up.
- **Siloed ownership** of data across departments.
- **Privacy and consent constraints** limiting what can be measured.
- **Analysis paralysis** — endless measurement substituting for decision.

5.8 Applying Digital Analytics — Worked Scenarios

5.8.1 Improving Customer Retention for a Food Delivery App

(CIE-III, June 2026, 10 marks — official scheme answer)

The app can analyse customer **ordering patterns, feedback and abandoned carts**. **Personalised offers, loyalty programmes and targeted notifications** can improve retention. Analytics helps identify customer needs and improve services effectively.

A fuller answer: (1) *Measure* — build cohort retention curves by acquisition source, and calculate churn rate, order frequency and average order value per segment. (2) *Segment* — identify the behaviours that distinguish retained from churned users, such as ordering within the first 7 days or using a saved address. (3) *Diagnose* — analyse cart abandonment reasons, delivery-time complaints and support tickets to locate the experience failure. (4) *Act* — trigger personalised offers based on past cuisine preference; run a win-back push after 14 inactive days; introduce a subscription pass for free delivery; add a loyalty streak to build habit; and fix the delivery-time promise that the data shows is most often broken. (5) *Measure again* — track Day-30 retention, repeat order rate and lifetime value against a control group to prove the change worked.

5.8.2 Maintaining Competitive Advantage in a Global Market

(CIE-III, June 2026, 10 marks — official scheme answer)

Digital analytics helps understand customer preferences, competitor trends and campaign effectiveness. **Website optimization** improves user experience and conversions. Together, they support better decision-making, customer engagement and global competitiveness.

A fuller answer: analytics provides market-by-market insight into what customers actually want, which channels perform in each region, and where competitors are gaining share; website optimization ensures that

the traffic won in each market converts, through localisation of language, currency, payment methods and page speed on regional networks; and the combination creates a **continuous feedback loop** in which the business learns faster than its competitors. Speed of learning, not size, is the durable advantage in a global digital market.

5.8.3 Refining Market Segmentation with Digital Analytics

SEE June/July 2025 asked (Q9b, 8 marks): *“Analyze how market segmentation can be refined using digital analytics data.”*

- **From demographic to behavioural segmentation** — traditional segmentation groups by age and income; analytics groups by what people actually *do*, which predicts purchase far better.
- **Value-based segmentation** — RFM analysis (Recency, Frequency, Monetary value) and lifetime-value modelling identify the segments worth investing in.
- **Journey-stage segmentation** — separating first-time visitors, researchers, cart abandoners, first-time buyers and loyalists, each requiring different messaging.
- **Intent-based segmentation** — search query and on-site behaviour reveal purchase intent in real time.
- **Channel-affinity segmentation** — which segment responds to which channel, enabling efficient allocation.
- **Predictive segmentation** — machine learning models group users by predicted churn risk or predicted conversion probability rather than by past attributes.
- **Continuous refinement** — analytics-driven segments update automatically as behaviour changes, whereas survey-based segments decay from the day they are created.

5.8.4 KPIs for Website Optimization and Their Effect on Conversions

SEE June/July 2025 asked (Q9a, 8 marks): *“What are the key performance indicators (KPIs) used to evaluate website optimization, and how do they contribute to increased conversions?”*

KPI	Contribution to conversions
Conversion rate	The direct measure — every other KPI exists to move this one
Bounce rate	Identifies pages where the visitor never enters the funnel at all
Average session duration & pages per session	Indicate whether the content sustains interest long enough to build desire
Page load time / Core Web Vitals	Each second of delay removes a measurable share of visitors before they see the offer
Exit rate by page	Pinpoints the specific page losing the customer
Cart abandonment rate	Isolates friction in the final Action step, usually the largest single recoverable loss
Form completion rate	Reveals whether the form itself is blocking the conversion
Click-through rate on CTAs	Tests whether the call to action is visible and persuasive
Scroll depth	Determines what must be moved above the fold
Mobile vs desktop conversion gap	Exposes device-specific failures hidden by the aggregate
Return visitor rate & repeat purchase rate	Measure the Satisfaction stage and long-term value
Cost per acquisition & ROAS	Connect optimisation work to profitability

5.8.5 Designing a Holistic Marketing Dashboard

SEE June/July 2025 asked (Q10a, 8 marks): “Design a basic digital dashboard that reflects holistic marketing performance.”

A good dashboard answers three questions in order — *are we growing?*, *which channels are working?*, and *where are we losing people?* — and every metric on it must be tied to a decision someone can make.

Dashboard section	Metrics	Decision it supports
1. Executive summary	Revenue, conversions, conversion rate, CAC, ROAS, LTV:CAC — each versus target and prior period	Is the business on plan?
2. Acquisition	Sessions and conversions by channel; spend, CPC and CPA per channel; new vs returning	Where should the next rupee of budget go?
3. Engagement	Bounce rate, session duration, pages per session, scroll depth, top and worst landing pages	Which content and pages need work?
4. Conversion funnel	Step-by-step drop-off from landing to purchase, split by device	Which single step do we fix first?
5. Retention & loyalty	Repeat purchase rate, cohort retention curves, churn, NPS, review sentiment	Are we keeping the customers we buy?
6. Channel deep-dives	SEO (impressions, rankings, organic sessions); e-mail (open, CTR, revenue per message); social (reach, engagement rate, share of voice); mobile (installs, DAU/MAU, retention)	Which channel-level tactic needs attention?
7. Technical health	Core Web Vitals, error rate, uptime, tracking integrity	Is anything silently broken?

DASHBOARD DESIGN PRINCIPLES

One screen, top-down importance. Show trend, not just the current value — a number without a comparison is meaningless. Always include the target alongside the actual. Segment by device and channel, because averages hide failures. Use colour only to signal status, never for decoration. And apply the same rule as web design: **if a metric drives no decision, delete it.**

5.9 Key Terms — Quick Revision

Term	One-line meaning
Conversion	A defined valuable action completed by a visitor
Conversion rate	$(\text{Conversions} \div \text{Total visitors}) \times 100$
CRO	Systematically increasing the % of visitors who convert, using data and experiments
AIDAS	Attention, Interest, Desire, Action, Satisfaction
AIDA	The classical four-stage model; AIDAS adds Satisfaction
Conversion funnel	The staged path from awareness to purchase and retention
Drop-off	The proportion of users lost between two funnel steps
Message match	Consistency between the ad or link and the landing page it leads to
Landing page	A single-purpose page built for one conversion
Above the fold	The area visible without scrolling
Social proof	People assuming others' actions reflect correct behaviour
Risk reversal	A guarantee or free-return policy that removes the buyer's perceived risk
A/B test	Splitting traffic between two versions to find the statistically better one
Cart abandonment rate	% who begin checkout but do not complete it
Digital analytics	Collection, measurement, analysis and interpretation of digital data to improve business performance and customer experience
End-to-end customer experience	The complete journey across all touchpoints, measured as one connected experience
Decision constellation	The non-linear network of simultaneous micro-decisions replacing the classic funnel
Multi-touch attribution	Distributing conversion credit across all contributing touchpoints
Last-click attribution	Crediting the final touchpoint only — the classic distortion
RFM analysis	Segmenting by Recency, Frequency and Monetary value
Cohort analysis	Tracking a group who share a start period over time
LTV : CAC	Lifetime value against customer acquisition cost — the core efficiency ratio
Churn rate	% of customers lost in a period
NPS	Net Promoter Score — likelihood of recommendation
CDP	Customer Data Platform — unifies customer data into one profile
HiPPO	"Highest Paid Person's Opinion" — the bias analytics exists to counter
Change agent	An analyst who drives decisions and organisational change, not just reports

5.10 Previous Year Questions — Unit V

A. Two-Mark Questions (Part A)

1. What does the AIDAS model stand for in conversion optimization? [Improvement CIE 4 Jun 2025]

Attention, Interest, Desire, Action, Satisfaction — the sequence of psychological states a prospect passes through from first exposure to post-purchase satisfaction.

2. Why is the ‘Satisfaction’ component important in the AIDAS model? [SEE Jun/Jul 2025]

Because the sale is not the end of the funnel. Satisfaction determines repurchase, retention and advocacy — and selling to an existing customer succeeds 60–70% of the time against 5–20% for a new prospect, with repeat customers spending up to 67% more. A dissatisfied customer also broadcasts the failure publicly, damaging future acquisition.

3. What is the role of AIDAS framework in the conversion optimization? [SEE Oct/Nov 2023]

It acts as a diagnostic and structuring tool — locating which psychological stage is failing (Attention, Interest, Desire, Action or Satisfaction), assigning each page section a defined job, sequencing the page accordingly, and generating testable optimisation hypotheses.

4. What is digital analytics? [CIE-III June 2026]

The collection, measurement, analysis and interpretation of digital data to improve business performance and customer experience.

5. How does digital analytics influence business decisions? [CIE-III June 2026]

It provides customer insights and performance data that help businesses improve marketing strategies and customer engagement — determining budget allocation, product development, segment targeting, experience priorities and forecasts.

6. What is meant by the “end-to-end customer experience” in digital analytics? [SEE Jun/Jul 2025]

Measuring and understanding the complete customer journey across every touchpoint and stage — from first impression through research, purchase, delivery and support to repeat purchase and advocacy — as one connected experience rather than as disconnected channel reports.

7. State two key elements that visitors commonly expect to see on a well-optimized landing page. [Improvement CIE 4 Jun 2025]

A clear benefit-led headline that matches the ad or link that brought them there, and a single prominent call-to-action button. (Also acceptable: trust signals such as testimonials or ratings; transparent pricing.)

8. What is Website Optimization? [CIE-III June 2026]

The process of improving website performance, speed, usability and search visibility in order to increase traffic and conversions.

9. What is the impact of user behavior analysis on website optimization? [SEE Oct/Nov 2023]

It reveals what users actually do rather than what is assumed — identifying friction, ignored content, invisible CTAs, rage clicks and true scroll depth — and produces the hypotheses that A/B testing then validates.

B. Ten-Mark and Eight-Mark Questions (Part B)

1. Explain the AIDAS model and its role in website conversion optimization. How can key elements of a website be optimized to increase landing page effectiveness? [Improvement CIE 4 Jun 2025]

Part one — define AIDAS and explain all five stages using the table in §5.2.2, then give the five points on its role in CRO from §5.2.4. Part two — take the key elements in turn (headline, CTA, visuals, forms, trust signals, speed and mobile) from §5.4 and give the specific optimisation for each. Close with the AIDAS-structured landing page layout in §5.2.5.

2. Explain the AIDAS model in detail. Discuss how each stage plays a critical role in conversion optimization, using examples to illustrate how businesses can enhance customer journeys through this model. [Improvement CIE 28 Aug 2024]

As above, but weight the answer towards **examples per stage**: *Attention* — a Netflix landing page whose entire first screen is one headline, one CTA and nothing else. *Interest* — a product page opening with three benefit bullets rather than technical specifications. *Desire* — Amazon placing star ratings and review counts directly above the buy button. *Action* — a one-tap checkout with saved payment details and guest checkout enabled. *Satisfaction* — an order-confirmation and proactive delivery-tracking sequence followed by a review request, converting the buyer into an advocate.

3. Analyze how a company can use the AIDAS model to structure content on its product landing page. [SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q10b]

See §5.2.5 — the section-by-section table mapping each part of the page to an AIDAS stage, closing with the structuring principle that a section with no assignable stage should be deleted.

4. Discuss what website visitors typically look for when they land on a business webpage. Suggest effective design and content strategies to meet those expectations. [Improvement CIE 4 Jun 2025]

See §5.3 — the ten visitor questions with the paired delivery for each, grounded in Krug's First Law and the scanning behaviour described in §5.3.1.

5. A travel agency has created a landing page for a limited-time offer on holiday packages. Despite a high number of clicks on the ads leading to the landing page, the conversion rate is disappointingly low. Evaluate the possible reasons for the low conversion rate on the landing page. Suggest optimizations for key elements such as headlines, call-to-action buttons, and visuals. [Improvement CIE 28 Aug 2024]

Diagnose with AIDAS. *Attention held* — the clicks prove the ad worked, so the failure is after arrival. *Interest failing* — poor message match between the ad promise and the page headline; the offer is below the fold. *Desire failing* — no testimonials, ratings, certifications or cancellation policy; pricing is opaque; no urgency despite the offer being time-limited; generic stock imagery. *Action failing* — competing CTAs or none dominant; a long enquiry form; site navigation letting visitors wander away; slow mobile load. **Optimizations — headline:** restate the ad promise with specifics, e.g. "Kerala backwaters, 4 nights from ₹18,999 — book by Sunday", with a sub-headline listing inclusions. **CTA:** one dominant high-contrast button repeated above and below the fold, active copy ("Reserve my package"), reassurance microcopy ("Free cancellation up to 7 days"). **Visuals:** real destination and customer photographs instead of stock, a short itinerary video, and a countdown timer. **Additional:** cut the form to three fields, place testimonials adjacent to the CTA, remove navigation from the landing page, and compress images for a sub-three-second mobile load. **Validate:** A/B test the headline and CTA, and confirm the fix through conversion rate, scroll depth and session recordings.

6. Trace the evolution of digital analytics and its growing importance in delivering a seamless end-to-end customer experience. [Improvement CIE 4 Jun 2025]

Give the six eras in §5.5.3 — server logs, page-tag web analytics, visitor and goal analytics, multi-channel and social analytics, user-centric event-based analytics, and unified predictive privacy-first analytics — with the tools and limitation of each. Then explain the direction of travel (counting files → predicting behaviour; silos → unified view), and connect it to the end-to-end customer experience material in §5.6, including the decision-constellation point and the seven requirements for genuine end-to-end

measurement.

7. A company plans to enter a competitive global market. Explain how digital analytics and website optimization can help maintain competitive advantage. [CIE-III June 2026]

See §5.8.2 — the official scheme answer expanded with market-by-market insight, localisation, and the argument that speed of learning is the durable advantage.

8. A food delivery app wants to improve customer retention. Apply digital analytics concepts to solve the problem. [CIE-III June 2026]

See §5.8.1 — the official scheme answer expanded into the five-step measure → segment → diagnose → act → re-measure structure.

9. Describe the conversion funnel in digital marketing. What are the key stages and how can business identify and address drop offs in the funnel? [SEE Oct/Nov 2023, Q9a]

See §5.1.3 — the five-stage funnel table with metrics and drop-off causes, the five identification methods, and the stage-by-stage remedies.

10. Explain the concept of social proof and its impact on conversion rates. Provide examples of how business can use social proof effectively in marketing. [SEE Oct/Nov 2023, Q9b]

See §5.4.5 — the definition, the impact argument grounded in the 90%-versus-48% trust asymmetry, and the ten types of social proof with usage guidance.

11. Define Digital Analytics. Describe the key metrics and KPIs used in digital analytics. How can these metrics help business measure the success of their online campaigns? [SEE Oct/Nov 2023, Q10a — 10 marks]

Define digital analytics (§5.5.1) and distinguish it from web analytics. Present the KPIs in structured families — *acquisition* (sessions, users, traffic by channel, CPC, CPA), *engagement* (bounce rate, session duration, pages per session, scroll depth), *conversion* (conversion rate, cart abandonment, form completion, revenue, AOV), *retention* (repeat purchase rate, churn, cohort retention, NPS, LTV), and *efficiency* (ROAS, LTV:CAC). Then explain how they measure campaign success: they attribute results to specific campaigns and channels, allow comparison against targets and prior periods, expose which stage of the funnel a campaign fails at, and convert marketing activity into financial terms the business can act on.

12. What are the key performance indicators (KPIs) used to evaluate website optimization, and how do they contribute to increased conversions? [SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q9a]

See §5.8.4 — the twelve KPIs with the specific contribution each makes to conversion.

13. Analyze how market segmentation can be refined using digital analytics data. [SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q9b]

See §5.8.3 — the seven refinements, from behavioural and value-based segmentation through to predictive segmentation and continuous automatic refresh.

14. Design a basic digital dashboard that reflects holistic marketing performance. [SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q10a]

See §5.8.5 — the seven-section dashboard with metrics and the decision each section supports, plus the design principles.

15. Demonstrate how tools like Google Analytics and Hotjar can be used to develop insights into user behavior and improve marketing decisions. [SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q7a]

Google Analytics supplies the *what* (quantitative) — channel performance, landing-page bounce rates, funnel drop-off, converting segments, cost per acquisition. **Hotjar supplies the *why* (qualitative)** —

heatmaps showing what attracts attention, scroll maps showing whether users reach the CTA, click maps exposing rage clicks on non-clickable elements, session recordings revealing hesitation, and on-page surveys capturing the abandonment reason in the user's own words. **Combined workflow:** GA shows the pricing page loses 60% of visitors → Hotjar recordings show users repeatedly clicking a static comparison table → the table is made interactive → an A/B test validates the change → GA confirms improved funnel conversion. This is the analyst-as-change-agent loop in §5.7.3 applied in practice.

HOW UNIT V IS EXAMINED

In the SEE, Unit V is **Questions 9 and 10 with internal choice** (16 marks in two 8-mark sub-divisions), plus 2–3 Part-A objective questions. In the Improvement CIEs it dominates alongside Unit IV. **AIDAS is effectively guaranteed** — it has appeared in every Unit V paper available, as both a 2-mark definition and a 10-mark explanation. The other high-probability topics are: **landing page optimisation for a low-converting page, the evolution of digital analytics, the conversion funnel and drop-off analysis, social proof, and KPIs and dashboards**. As in Unit IV, most Part-B questions are scenarios — answer with the AIDAS diagnostic structure or the measure → diagnose → hypothesise → test → implement → re-measure loop rather than general commentary.